DAVIDE TAGLIALATELA

taglialatela@g.harvard.edu
Cell 857-999-6862
davide-taglialatela.github.io

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Littauer Center
1805 Cambridge St
Cambridge MA 02138

Placement Director: Myrto Kalouptsidi myrto@fas.harvard.edu 617-495-2144
Placement Director: Oleg Itskhoki itskhoki@fas.harvard.edu 617-495-2144
Administrative Director: Brenda Piquet bpiquet@harvard.edu 617-495-8927

Education

Harvard University
Ph.D. Economics, 2020 to 2027 (expected)

Bocconi University, Italy
M.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2020
B.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2017

Fields

Financial Economics
Behavioral Economics
Climate Finance

References

Professor Xavier Gabaix
Harvard University
xgabaix@fas.harvard.edu

Professor Andrei Shleifer
Harvard University
shleifer@fas.harvard.edu

Professor Marco Sammon
Harvard Business School
msammon@hbs.edu

Professor Adi Sunderam
Harvard Business School
asunderam@hbs.edu

Fellowships, Grants & Awards

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard Griffin GSAS, 2026–2027
Molly and Domenic Ferrante Economics Research Fund, 2026
Ross Garon and Anna Suh Family Foundation Economics Research Fund, 2025
Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center, Harvard University, 2022, 2023
Bocconi Graduate Merit Award, Bocconi University, 2017

Teaching

Teaching Fellow, Harvard University
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Daniel Graves, Spring 2026
Corporate Finance (undergraduate), Daniel Bergstresser, Fall 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Weiling Liu, Spring 2025
Quantitative Methods in Economics (undergraduate), Davide Viviano, Spring 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Xavier Gabaix and Matthew Pritsker, Spring 2023
Psychology and Economic Theory (Ph.D.), Matthew Rabin, Fall 2022, Fall 2023

Research

Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Andrei Shleifer, 2022–2025
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Matthew Rabin, 2021
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Stefanie Stantcheva, 2019–2020
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Alberto Alesina, 2018
Visiting Student, IGIER, Bocconi University, Professor Francesco Giavazzi, 2018–2020

Job Market Paper

What a Disaster Means: Attention, Interpretation, and the Demand for Green Assets

How events are interpreted locally substantially shapes portfolio choices, fund flows, and asset prices. In the setting of extreme weather events, I use fine-tuned large language models on 1.5 million articles from U.S. news outlets to construct a new measure of local event interpretation that

distinguishes attention to a disaster from coverage explicitly linking it to climate change. I combine this measure with geographically identified portfolios of household-serving advisers and mutual fund managers. Among disaster-affected counties, stronger climate interpretation leads to reallocation toward green ETFs in household portfolios. The relationship extends to ESG mutual-fund inflows and to nearby fund managers, who tilt their active trading toward greener firms as climate-linked coverage rises. Predetermined county and investor characteristics and the direct economic effects of the disaster are not driving the responses. Using changes in the ownership structure of the county's newspapers, I show that locally supplied climate interpretation narratives move households' and fund managers' portfolios independently of readers' prior beliefs and preferences. In a counterfactual in which disasters activate the entire institutional investor base, an interquartile increase in climate interpretation implies a relative appreciation of green stocks equal to 15.2% of the observed annual green return spread.
[Latest draft available here]

Papers in Progress

"Are You Asking the Right Questions? An Experiment on Investors' Demand for Information" (with Marcela Carvalho and Beatrice Ferrario)

Provides an incentivized and unconstrained measure of retail investors' decision-relevant mental models from their revealed information preferences: the questions they ask an AI chatbot while making investment decisions. Uses it to study retail investors' persistent stock picking despite poor average performance.

"The Structure of Disagreement: Belief Systems and Cultural Divides in the United States"

Documents that trends in convergence, disagreement, and polarization of views in the United States have been strongly issue-specific and, therefore, incompatible with a single left–right political divide. Studies this heterogeneity through belief systems, positing that the observed pattern is driven by changes in the latent structures that jointly organize views across issues.

Seminars & Conferences

New England Economics Ph.D. Conference (Brown University, 2025)

Ph.D. Summer Schools & Other Training

Financial Economics of Climate and Sustainability (FECS), Global Doctoral Reading Group, Salata Institute, Harvard University, Spring 2026
Deep Learning for Dynamic Stochastic Models, University of Turin, 2025
Large Language Models in Finance, Barcelona School of Economics, 2025
NLP and Large Language Models, Barcelona School of Economics, 2025
Computational and Experimental Economics, BESLab, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, 2023
Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money and Finance, Princeton University, 2022
Behavioral Finance, Yale University, 2022
Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics, Russell Sage Foundation, 2022
Using Text as Data: Methods and Applications, Barcelona School of Economics, 2021
Summer School in Advanced Statistics and Probability – Random Graphs and Complex Networks: Structure and Function, Bocconi University, 2019
Tools for Macroeconomists: Advanced Tools, London School of Economics, 2018

Languages

Italian (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

Software skills

R, Python, MATLAB, Julia, LaTeX, JavaScript and HTML/CSS (for Qualtrics applications), Excel, and Access (*International Computer Driving Licence*, Advanced Certificate, 2016)

Personal information

Citizenship: Italian
Voice type: Baritone
Boxing stance: Southpaw